

through several steps in the conventional way.

4.3.3 Email

One of the most important aspects of a Windows Mobile device is the possibility to check email. Mobile email is an important part of business life: around 33 per cent of mobile users use their mobile phone to retrieve email and around 2/3rds of the executives use mobile email. So a good email client makes a lot of (business) users happy. Email is a lot smarter on Windows Mobile 6 than most smartphones.

It ships with Microsoft's Direct Push technology so you get real-time email delivery and automatic synchronisation with your Outlook calendar, tasks, and contacts via Exchange Server. You can search even search your company server for emails that aren't stored locally on your device by tapping into Exchange 2007. You can then download individual attachments without having to sit through an entire Send/Receive operation. And Exchange Server 2007-WM6 users will love the fact that they can set their out-of-office message directly from their devices, even if owning a WM6 smart phone means never having to do that.

Exchange users don't reap all the benefits. By moving its database of email settings for various service providers to the web and keeping it always up to date, setting up new accounts is much less cumbersome with WM6, compared with WM5 and is similar to the experience on Nokia's Symbian Smartphones.

Microsoft has also added nine new one-click shortcuts, as we noted above, for flagging, deleting, or moving messages. Just press and hold the H key when you're in the Inbox to see the list of shortcuts at any time. Plus, you get more of the true Outlook experience as your Inbox view shows messages that are flagged, marked as high importance, and so forth.

Searching for e-mails is no longer an unpleasant task such as in previous WinMo versions, thanks to SmartFilter. It works very similar to the Smart Dial feature. Anything that reduces key presses is good. Just start typing while you're in your Inbox and the software automatically displays messages with that key phrase, whether it's a part of the sender's name or in the subject line. It's truly a timesaver and makes finding emails very easy.

There is, of course, support for POP3 and IMAP accounts. The e-mail application also supports and displays HTML e-mails from POP3/IMAP, Windows Live Mail and Exchange 2007 accounts, using the Internet Explorer Mobile engine to show inline graphics and formatting. As always, sometimes you have to scroll horizontally when graphics are wide, but it's a good step. If there happens to be a

